The Dhāraṇī for Protecting Oneself

Toh 1028 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī for Protecting Oneself is a very brief protective incantation from the Buddhist tradition. After a homage to the Three Jewels, it gives a short mantra and a simple ritual instruction. The practitioner faces the sun, recites the mantra seven times over water, and then scatters the water in the ten directions to secure personal protection. The source lines do not clearly preserve its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles, but the text identifies itself by this name in its closing line. It is Toh 1028 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the large class of dhāraṇī texts, short spells and formulas valued for their protective power.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

tadyathā oṃ ale kāli ale kāli mucci te svāhā

Facing the sun, recite this mantra seven times over water and scatter the water in the ten directions, and one's self will be protected.

The Dhāraṇī for Protecting Oneself is complete.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.